CAPE COD EXTERIOR CHECKLIST

7 Signs Your House Needs Paint

Walk around your home with this list. It takes about 5 minutes.

- [ ] **01** Peeling or bubbling paint
  Once paint lifts, water gets behind it and starts rotting the wood underneath.
- [ ] **02** Faded or chalky siding
  Rub it with your hand. White powder means the paint has stopped protecting the surface.
- [ ] **03** Soft or rotted trim
  Press with a screwdriver. If it sinks in, rot is spreading and repair costs grow every season.
- [ ] **04** Mildew or black stains
  Cape Cod humidity feeds mildew, which eats into paint and holds moisture against the wood.
- [ ] **05** Gaps in caulking around windows
  Open joints let rain blow inside the walls, where you can't see the damage.
- [ ] **06** Cracked paint on doors
  Doors take sun, salt and daily use. Cracks let moisture swell the wood so it sticks and splits.
- [ ] **07** Last painted 7+ years ago
  On the Cape, salt air and sun wear exterior paint faster. 7 years is a good time to check.

Checked 2 or more? Your house is asking for help.

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